



Photo shows Ellie, the little fawn, as a style reference, not the activity cube itself.

LME CROCHET PATTERN - BABY

ELLIE'S ACTIVITY TOY

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A soft activity cube, approx. 11 to 12 cm per side, full of things to explore on each of the six sides: Ellie with a bow, a baby-safe mirror in a flower frame, four simple shapes, Ellie peeking out of a little pocket, and a lacing side with cord and crocheted eyelets. Two wooden corner rings and a bead trim along the top complete the cube.

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IMPORTANT: This toy has many small parts. Read the whole safety page carefully before you start, and sew absolutely everything on with tight, double stitching.

ABOUT ELLIE'S ACTIVITY TOY

PART OF ELLIE'S WORLD

Ellie's activity toy belongs to the LME Baby Collection "Woodland Dreams". The cube gathers Ellie's whole world across six small sides: Ellie herself with her bow, the mirror where the child meets their own reflection, shapes from the forest, the pocket where Ellie peeks out, and the lacing side that trains little fingers.

STYLE AND SENSES

Scandinavian and Montessori-inspired, in the same natural colours as the rest of the collection. Each side has its own task to explore, from recognising shapes to practising lacing a cord, exactly the kind of practical, hands-on play the Montessori philosophy is built on.

MOST IMPORTANT OF ALL: SAFETY

This toy has more small parts than any other pattern in the collection, and also includes a small mirror, two wooden rings and a lacing cord. Everything must be sewn on with double strength, and page 18 is entirely dedicated to safety. Read that page carefully before you begin.

MATERIALS AND YARN ALTERNATIVES

YARN

Bystrikk Merino in cream (the cube sides) and light brown (the edging colour and Ellie's head), plus leftover powder pink, sage green, yellow and light sky blue, the same yarn family as the rest of the Ellie collection.

Alternative yarn: any soft cotton-blend DK-weight yarn works well, for example DROPS Safran or Hobbii Amigo.

TOOLS AND SUPPLIES

- Heklenål 3 eller 3,5 mm
- Seks tynne skumkvadrater eller stiv filtplate, ca. 10 x 10 cm · BPA-fri, til å gi kubens form, skal alltid være helt innsydd
- Polyesterfiber til fyll · til hjørner/kanter og til Ellie-motivene
- Babysikkert speil (akryl/plast, ikke glass) · liten, rund speilplate beregnet for babyprodukter, se side om speilet
- To trerelaterte teetheringer · umalt/BPA-fri, CE-merket, beregnet for barn, til hjørnene
- Runde treperler i noen få størrelser · BPA-frie, til topphåndtaket og hjørneduskene
- Kort flettesnor av bomull, ca. 40 til 50 cm · til flettesiden
- Stoppenål med butt spiss og tvinnnet bomullstråd · til all somming
- Saks og målebånd

DIFFICULTY, SIZE AND GAUGE

DIFFICULTY

Medium to challenging: many small parts, six panels that must all match in size, and a technique new to the collection, sewing the panels together into a three-dimensional cube. A good pattern once you have crocheted at least one of the other Ellie patterns first.

FINISHED SIZE

The cube is approx. 11 to 12 cm per side, depending on your gauge and the thickness of the inner stiffening.

GAUGE

Crochet tightly, amigurumi tension: approx. 20 sc x 22 rows = 10 x 10 cm on a 3 mm hook.

ABBREVIATIONS (NORWEGIAN AND US)

Here are all the abbreviations used in this pattern, with the common US crochet terms alongside.

Norwegian	US	Means
lm	ch	luftmaske / chain
fm	sc	fastmaske / single crochet
halvstav	hdc	halv stav / half double crochet
stav	dc	stav / double crochet
kjm	sl st	kjedemaske / slip stitch
økn	inc	økning: 2 fm i samme maske
mink	dec	minking: 2 fm sammen
m	st(s)	maske(r)
...	*...*	gjenta det mellom stjernene så mange ganger som står bak

TIPS BEFORE YOU START

- Crochet all six base squares first, and check that they are exactly the same size before starting on the decorative motifs.
- Lay all the finished sides next to each other and plan which side should face which way, before sewing anything together.
- Insert the foam squares last, right before sewing the final seam closed, so the cube holds its shape without making the sewing difficult.

HOW THE ACTIVITY CUBE IS BUILT

The cube has six sides. Five of them each have their own motif, the last is the bottom and is kept completely plain:

1. The base squares

six matching panels with an edging colour

3. The mirror side

baby-safe mirror in a flower frame

5. The pocket side

a miniature Ellie peeking out of a pocket

7. The bottom

plain, without decoration

9. The top handle

a bead trim along the top seam

2. The Ellie side

the front, with a bow and a ruffled collar

4. The shapes side

heart, star, circle and triangle

6. The lacing side

six crocheted eyelets and a cord

8. Assembly and stiffening

the six sides sewn into a cube

10. The corner rings and tassels

two wooden rings and two bead tassels

PART 1: THE BASE SQUARES

All six sides of the cube start as the same simple square. Crochet the motifs onto them afterwards, side by side.

Chain 24 + 1 turning chain in cream. Row 1: 24 sc. Repeat row 1 (turning between each row) until the piece is square, approx. 11 x 11 cm, roughly 22 to 24 rows depending on your gauge. Fasten off. Crochet six matching squares in total.

Edge each square with one round of sc in light brown all the way around (sc evenly along the sides, 3 sc in each corner so it lies flat). Fasten off and weave in the end. This gives the light border you see around each side in the reference photo.

PART 2: THE ELLIE SIDE

The front of the cube is Ellie herself, with a bow and a little ruffled collar, the same technique as on the rattle and the stroller toy's medallion.

Rnd	Description	Sts
1	6 sc in a magic ring, brown	6
2	inc x 6	12
3	(1 sc, inc) x 6	18
4	(2 sc, inc) x 6	24
5 to 6	24 sc, 2 rounds	24
7	(2 sc, dec) x 6 - stuff very lightly	18
8	dec x 6	9

Cut, leaving a long tail. Sew on two small ears (5 sc in a magic ring, fasten off, make 2) on top, and embroider a small face.

The bow: crochet a narrow strip in powder pink, chain 16 + 1 turning chain, 1 row of sc (16 sc). Fold the strip into a bow shape and sew it tightly together at the centre several times, as described in Ellie's own main pattern. Sew the bow on permanently and flat, at the top between the ears. Unlike on the Ellie toy itself, this bow should NOT be removable, since it is sewn directly onto a flat panel.

The ruffled collar: attach powder pink yarn at the bottom edge of the head. *1 sc in the next stitch, skip 1 stitch, 5 dc in the next stitch (a little fan), skip 1 stitch*, repeat all the way around the bottom edge. Fasten off. Finally, sew Ellie's head securely onto the middle of the panel.

PART 3: THE MIRROR SIDE (BABY-SAFE)

The mirror is the only hard part in this toy, and requires extra care.

Crochet two matching circles in cream, a little bigger than the mirror disc itself: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), (2 sc, inc) x 6 (24). Place the mirror disc between the two circles, and sew them together around the entire edge with very tight stitches, so the mirror is fully enclosed and cannot be removed or slide out of the pocket.

The flower frame: attach powder pink yarn directly into the outer edge of the sewn-in mirror circle, and crochet one round: 24 sc all the way around. Continue straight into the petals, without joining the round: *skip 1 st, in the next st: 1 sl st, 2 ch, 3 dc, 2 ch, 1 sl st*, repeat until you have eight petals all the way around the mirror. Fasten off and weave in the end. Sew the mirror with its flower frame securely onto the middle of the panel.

Use only a flexible, unbreakable baby-safe mirror intended for children's products, never real glass. Check that the mirror disc has no sharp edges before you insert it.

PART 4: THE SHAPES SIDE

Four simple, recognisable shapes, a nice start to shape recognition for little ones.

THE HEART (POWDER PINK)

Crochet two matching halves: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), fasten off (make 2). Sew the two halves together along a straight edge at the top, and gently press them down towards a point at the bottom, into a heart shape. Press flat and sew on.

THE STAR (SAGE GREEN)

Crochet 5 sc in a magic ring. Continue straight into the points: *1 sc, 3 ch, sl st in the same stitch*, repeat until all 5 stitches have a point. Fasten off, leaving a long tail, press flat and sew on.

THE CIRCLE (YELLOW)

Crochet 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18). Fasten off, press flat. Feel free to embroider a small spiral in the centre with contrasting thread, just like in the reference photo, before sewing the circle on.

THE TRIANGLE (LIGHT SKY BLUE)

Chain 7. Row 1: sc in the 2nd ch from the hook and along the rest (6 sc). Row 2: dec 1 at each end (4 sc). Row 3: dec 1 at each end (2 sc). Row 4: dec the last two stitches together into one (1 sc). Fasten off, press flat and sew on.

PART 5: THE POCKET SIDE

A tiny miniature Ellie peeks up out of a pocket at the bottom of the panel, a little peekaboo surprise.

The pocket: chain 12 + 1 turning chain in sage green. Row 1: 12 sc. Repeat row 1 for 8 rows in total. Fold the piece in half and sew together along the two short sides and the bottom, so it becomes a small, open pocket. Sew the pocket's bottom edge onto the bottom of the panel, with the opening facing up.

Miniature Ellie: 6 sc in a magic ring, brown (6), inc x 6 (12), (1 sc, inc) x 6 (18), 1 round straight (18), dec x 6 (9), stuff very lightly. Fasten off, leaving a long tail. Sew on two tiny ears and embroider a small face, just like on the Ellie side.

Sew the miniature Ellie securely just behind the pocket opening, a little higher than the pocket itself, so that only the head pokes up out of the pocket, as if she is peeking out. Ellie must be sewn completely onto the panel, not just placed loosely inside the pocket.

PART 6: THE LACING SIDE

This side trains fine motor skills, just like tying shoes. Six crocheted eyelets and a short cord.

The eyelets: crochet six small, firm rings in light brown, 6 sc in a magic ring, sl st to close, fasten off leaving a long tail (make 6). Sew each ring securely on, three on each side of the panel, evenly spaced as in the reference photo. A crocheted ring acts as a safe eyelet, with no sharp edges. Never use metal eyelets or rivets here.

Attach the short lacing cord permanently, with several stitches, in the bottom eyelet. Lace the cord upward in a crisscross between the remaining eyelets, just like lacing a shoe, and finish with a simple bow at the top. LME recommends that the total cord length, from the fixed attachment point to the end of the bow, never exceeds approx. 30 cm, and that the starting point is always sewn on, never loose.

PART 7: ASSEMBLING THE CUBE

The bottom is kept completely plain, without decoration, in cream with the same edging colour as the others. Then you sew all six sides together into a cube.

- 1 Lay out the six finished panels in the order you want them: the Ellie side at the front, the lacing side at the back, the mirror side and the shapes side on either side, the pocket side on top, and the bottom underneath.
- 2 Sew together five of the six seams with tight edging stitches or a whip stitch, right sides out, so you have an open cube with only one hole left.
- 3 Insert the six foam squares, one into each side, through the last open hole, along with a little loose stuffing in the corners for a soft feel.
- 4 Sew the last hole closed just as tightly and securely as the other five seams.
- 5 Go over all six seams once more on the outside, with tight stitches, for extra strength where little hands will pull and squeeze.

PART 8: THE TOP HANDLE

Thread a selection of round wooden beads and yarn-covered balls (powder pink, sage green, cream, light sky blue and yellow, just like on Ellie's stroller toy) onto a short, sturdy cotton cord, in whatever order you like. Sew both ends of the cord securely along the top seam, between the Ellie side and the pocket side, so the row of beads forms a small arch over the top, like a handle.

The bead balls are crocheted just like the balls on the pacifier clip: 6 sc in a magic ring, inc x 6 (12), 12 sc for 2 rounds, dec x 6 (6), stuff lightly and fasten off.

PART 9: THE CORNER RINGS AND TASSELS

Sew a wooden teething ring securely into each of the two vertical seams flanking the Ellie side (the seam towards the mirror side on one side, the seam towards the shapes side on the other), so the rings hang as in the reference photo. Each ring must be sewn on with several rounds of tight whip stitching, not just threaded loosely through the seam.

Make two short bead tassels: thread 2 to 3 balls/beads (for example one yarn-covered ball, one wooden bead, one yarn-covered ball) onto a short cotton cord, no more than 6 to 8 cm long, and sew the fixed attachment point securely right next to each corner ring. No loop should be loose or long enough to stretch out beyond 8 cm.

ASSEMBLY, STEP BY STEP

- 1 Crochet the six base squares and edge them all in light brown.
- 2 Crochet the Ellie side, the mirror side, the shapes side, the pocket side and the lacing side, each onto its own base square. Leave the bottom plain.
- 3 Sew five of the seams together into an open cube, insert the foam squares and a little stuffing, and sew the last seam closed.
- 4 Attach the top handle along the top seam.
- 5 Attach the two corner rings and the two bead tassels into the seams flanking the Ellie side.
- 6 Attach the cord on the lacing side at the bottom eyelet, and lace it upward.
- 7 Fasten every loose end securely on the inside of the pieces, and trim what is left.
- 8 Gently tug on every single part, ring, tassel and the lacing cord's attachment point, to check that nothing comes loose, before the toy is used.

PHOTO GUIDE

Add your own photos of each step here once you have crocheted the activity cube yourself.



The six sides, crocheted



The cube sewn together



Corner rings and top handle



The finished cube

SAFETY, THE MOST IMPORTANT PAGE

MANY SMALL PARTS, ONE RULE: SEW EVERYTHING ON

This toy has more motifs and more different materials (yarn, wood, mirror, cord) than any other pattern in the Ellie collection. Every single motif, every ring and every bead must be sewn on with strong, twisted cotton thread and plenty of tight stitches, going around at least twice. The mirror must always be fully enclosed in a closed pocket, never loose in the regular stuffing.

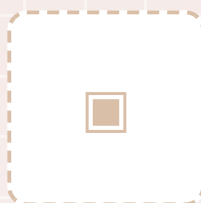
MORE IMPORTANT RULES

- Always use under adult supervision, especially the first few times, until you are confident every seam holds.
- No parts are glued. Everything is sewn on, nothing is attached with paperclips, safety pins or similar.
- Use only a baby-safe acrylic/plastic mirror, never real glass or a mirror intended for adults.
- The lacing cord must always be fixed with sewing at the bottom eyelet at one end, and never more than approx. 30 cm in total. Never leave a longer cord loose, and never let it hang freely around a neck.
- The corner rings' bead tassels must never be longer than approx. 6 to 8 cm, and must be sewn on, not just threaded loosely.
- The foam squares must always be fully enclosed inside the cube, never accessible or visible through an open seam.
- Check the toy regularly, and especially before every use: gently tug on every motif, ring and the cord. Discard or repair immediately if anything is loose.
- This pattern is a guide for home use. If the finished product is sold, it must always be checked, tested and marked as required under current local safety requirements and regulations for children's products/toys, which set strict requirements specifically for toys with many small, sewn-on parts and cords.

CARE AND WASHING

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with a little mild soap, since the cube has many sewn parts and an inner stiffening. Rinse well. Gently press out the water in a towel, do not wring. Lay flat to dry, allowing plenty of time for the inner stiffening to dry completely, and check every seam carefully before using the toy again.

VIDEO GUIDE



QR code to video guide (to be added)

CONGRATULATIONS, THE ACTIVITY CUBE IS DONE!

Now you have crocheted the most detailed pattern in the whole Ellie collection.
Well done, and happy exploring!

THE REST OF THE LME BABY COLLECTION

- Ellie, the little fawn
- Ellie's pacifier clip
- Ellie's rattle
- Ellie's stroller toy
- Ellie's ballerina shoes with a bow

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